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Items marked *pre-window onset* began shortly before the window opened but were reported within it. Text marked **Assessment** is analytic judgment using ICD 203 estimative language. Everything else is reporting attributed to the cited source. US daylight saving time ended on 1 November; Eastern times in this edition are EST (UTC-5).

// BOTTOM LINE UP FRONT

- **CENTCOM:** Trump says he is "not in a hurry" on Iran and Rubio says no strike decision has been made, while Iran's Supreme Leader ordered a "geographically unrestricted response" to any attack. Rezaei confirmed receipt of the Vance letter but has not replied, and Araghchi says a Doha-mediated proposal could reopen Hormuz within two days. The Saudi-led coalition launched an operation against Houthi resources, hitting Ras Isa port. Bennett's party will back Eisenkot, and Herzog begins consultations on 4 November. [14][15][18][23][27][29]
- **EUCOM:** The Oleshky truce expired on 1 November after about 800 evacuations, and Kyiv says Russia used it to regroup. Russia launched 433 drones on the night of 31 October and Ukraine resumed strikes on Russian refineries. The Kremlin says Putin would take a call from Zelensky and talks could resume after 4 November. France's 31 October protests drew fewer people but ended in 779 arrests. [43][42][44][49][52][54]
- **AFRICOM:** The UN mission in Western Sahara has ended after a Russian veto. Sudan now accuses Ethiopia of arming the RSF as drones push Sudan's power grid toward collapse. Congo's Ebola deaths passed 5,000 and Nigeria is testing two suspected cases in the northeast. [1][2][3][4][5][6]
- **INDOPACOM:** North Korea tested a cluster-bomb warhead on 31 October, but its border loudspeakers stayed silent past the end-of-October deadline. A Chinese coast guard ship entered restricted waters at Pratas, and an unidentified Chinese vessel is operating inside the Scarborough Shoal lagoon. Japan is weighing a defence plan of about $500bn. [58][63][64][68][71]

- **NORTHCOM:** A federal judge barred DOJ and DHS from pressuring election officials over disputed ballots, and the Ninth Circuit again refused to stop California counting about 20,000 ballots. DOJ plans about 1,000 election monitors for Tuesday, and several states will restrict their access. Sinaloa recorded its most violent month. [78][80][81][85]
- **SOUTHCOM:** Trump says Flávio Bolsonaro "can stay as long as he wants," and Rubio denies the US helped him leave Brazil. Colombia's sixth air strike on the Clan del Golfo killed at least seven, including a senior commander. Gangs in Port-au-Prince are barricading districts ahead of expected Salvadoran operations. [94][95][96][99][100]

// AFRICOM

WESTERN SAHARA: UN mission ends after 35 years following Security Council deadlock

On 30 October Russia vetoed a US draft, backed by 11 members, that would have renewed MINURSO for a year, dropped "referendum" from its name and made Morocco's autonomy plan the only basis for talks. A Russian rollover draft won only two votes. [1] On 1 November Guterres confirmed the mandate had expired and the mission has entered a "liquidation phase," saying he "remains concerned about the security situation" and urging "maximum restraint." Morocco called the outcome a "significant development" and asked UN staff to leave; Algeria expressed "deep regret" and blamed US bias. MINURSO had 155 military personnel. [2] *Pre-window onset.*

Assessment: The loss of the only international ceasefire monitor along the berm likely raises the risk of Polisario-Moroccan clashes and of further Algerian-Moroccan friction.

SUDAN / ETHIOPIA: Khartoum accuses Ethiopia of arming the RSF as drones target the grid

Drones knocked out substations at Al-Dabbah, where a guard was killed, and Abu Hamad on 1 November, after earlier strikes on the 500 MW Um Dabakir plant and Shendi's main substation. Emergency Lawyers count 15 substations hit since early October, and output has fallen to 1,100 MW from 4,400 MW before the war. [3] On 31 October a Foreign Ministry undersecretary told diplomats in Port Sudan that Ethiopia's Asosa base "has become a hub for supplying the rebel militia with weapons" and said Sudan retains the right to respond. [4] Ethiopia and the UAE have previously denied arming the RSF and had not responded to the new claims.

Assessment: Khartoum has moved from alleging drone launches to alleging Ethiopian logistics support, which likely raises the risk of Sudanese action against Ethiopian territory.

DRC / REGION: Ebola deaths pass 5,000; Nigeria tests two suspected cases in the northeast

Congo's Health Ministry reports 5,026 deaths among 10,351 infections in 67 health zones across eight provinces. Africa CDC says about 80% of new cases come from outside known contact chains, and WHO says about a third of deaths occur before testing. AP puts Kenya at eight cases and two deaths; WHO's 23 October update gave nine cases and one death. [5] On 31 October Nigeria's NCDC isolated two suspected cases in the northeast; results are pending. [6]

Assessment: Confirmed transmission in northeast Nigeria would be a serious escalation given the insurgency and weak surveillance there.

ETHIOPIA: Drone strikes in Amhara and Tigray kill at least 25; Eritrea reportedly backing the TPLF

Witnesses told AFP that four drone strikes on a displacement camp in Amhara on 29 October killed 14-15 people, and a strike in Rama, Tigray, on 30 October killed 11-13 people collecting grain. ACLED attributes the

Tigray strike to the federal army, which did not comment. AFP reports the army has reached the Eritrean border and that Eritrea has sent troops to support the TPLF. [7] *Pre-window onset.*

Assessment: Ethiopia's two-front drone campaign, alongside its dispute with Sudan, raises the risk of an Ethiopia-Eritrea war on the northern border.

SOMALIA: UN political mission closes; pirates seize an Iranian fishing vessel

UNTMIS ceased operations on 31 October, ending more than three decades of UN political engagement, while the opposition disputes the government's claim that the president and parliament can stay until 2027. [8] Puntland maritime police say 12 pirates hijacked the Iranian fishing vessel Azini with 21 Iranian crew and two Somali guards between Bandar Bayla and Hafun; maritime monitors warned it is nearing a shipping lane and EUNAVFOR Atalanta is investigating. [9] Israel's first ambassador to Somaliland has presented credentials in Hargeisa, and President Mohamud said "Israel wants the Red Sea." [10]

Assessment: The end of UN mediation during an election dispute, together with a possible pirate mother ship, adds political and maritime risk.

SUDAN: Senior RSF commander defects

In video obtained by Al Jazeera, senior RSF commander Siddiq Ander said he had defected and called the RSF "a purely family-based project controlled by Hemedti's relatives." It follows earlier 2026 defections, including a lieutenant colonel who left with 300 personnel on 8 October. [11]

Assessment: Repeated defections point to internal strain, but there is no sign yet that the RSF drone campaign is weakening.

NIGERIA: Army says 48 insurgents killed repelling attacks in Borno and Yobe

A military spokesperson said troops with air support repelled overnight attacks on a base at Bitta and a training school at Buni Yadi, killing 48 insurgents for the loss of one soldier. Reuters notes attacks on bases have surged in recent weeks. The figures are military claims and cannot be verified. [12]

Assessment: Continued ISWAP pressure on bases in the northeast matters more now that suspected Ebola cases have appeared there.

DRC / RUSSIA: Tshisekedi asks Putin for help with Rwanda and MONUSCO

At the close of the Russia-Africa summit, Tshisekedi said he "absolutely" wanted Russian help "in the search for peace" with Rwanda and asked for Russian support to renew MONUSCO, whose mandate expires in December. [13]

Assessment: Kinshasa is seeking Russian diplomatic cover as an alternative to the US-led track, days after Washington sanctioned Rwanda's Defence Ministry.

Collection gap: No verified weekend reporting on Algerian movement into Niger, Mali's JNIM blockade, Burkina Faso, ground fighting in El Fasher or Kordofan, eastern DRC, Libya after the central bank raid, or Tanzania before the 6 November Lissu verdict. Hiiraan Online, Sudan Tribune, Addis Standard and Channels TV did not load.

// CENTCOM

US / IRAN: No strike decision; Trump "not in a hurry"

At Mar-a-Lago on 31 October Trump said "we're not in that much of a hurry" because "we've knocked out their navy," adding that "one or two sites" remain and "we can do that in 10 minutes." [14][15] The Times of Israel reports he named Pickaxe Mountain, a suspected nuclear-material storage site not yet struck. [16] Rubio said Trump "hasn't made a decision" and prefers a diplomatic outcome. CBS relays an AP report that the US has moved many assets out of the Gulf, and CENTCOM says its blockade has turned back 144 vessels. [15] Fox News reports more strikes are "not likely before midterms." [17]

Assessment: Washington's public line has shifted from imminent action to "no decision," so any strike is more likely after polls close on 3 November than before.

IRAN: Rezaei confirms Vance letter but no reply; Hormuz offer cut to two days

Rezaei said Tehran has received the Vance letter, has not answered it and called its "change in tone" "positive." [18][14] Araghchi said "a new proposal has been reached with mediators" after Qatari and Pakistani mediators met an Iranian delegation in Doha, and that it could reopen the Strait of Hormuz within two days instead of seven; he said there are no plans to meet US officials directly. [15][18] Rezaei listed conditions for normal transit: lifting the blockade, oil sanctions waivers, unfrozen assets, an end to fighting on all fronts including Lebanon, and recognition of an Iran-Oman arrangement for the strait. [18] Fox News, citing AP, says the US rejected Iran's earlier one-week proposal. [17]

Assessment: Each side is waiting for the other to move first, so the letter is likely to stay unanswered unless Washington offers something concrete on the blockade or sanctions.

IRAN: Supreme Leader orders "geographically unrestricted response"; officials threaten undersea cables

On 31 October Mojtaba Khamenei ordered that any threat be met with "an immediate, impactful and geographically unrestricted response." [15] Al Jazeera reports he called for "maximum deterrence" against US and Israeli assets. Officials warned that regional seabed cables could become targets if civilian infrastructure is hit again, and state media aired footage of missiles and drones leaving underground storage. The Passive Defence chief said "network islanding" of the grid is being considered. [18]

Assessment: The cable threat is a new escalation option, and the missile footage is likely meant to show Iran can still retaliate before 3 November.

STRAIT OF HORMUZ: New projectile strike; Qatari LNG carrier attacked; Oman rescues tanker crew

UKMTO reported on 1 November that a merchant vessel in the strait was hit by an unknown projectile, based on a mayday relayed by another ship; no vessel type or damage was given. The Qatar News Agency said the LNG carrier Al Mayeda was attacked by "unidentified objects" on 30 October with no injuries. [19][20] Oman's navy evacuated 25 crew from the burning Panama-flagged tanker RITI, and CENTCOM's commander said US forces had "successfully cleared" the main routes of Iranian mines. [21] Accounts of a Saturday strike near Lavan Island conflict: Al Jazeera says UKMTO reported an LPG carrier hit by "three Iranian projectiles," while Shafaq News reported the UKMTO warning just before the window with no attribution. [18][22]

Assessment: Attacks on shipping have continued during diplomatic contacts. Hitting a Qatari carrier while Doha mediates is notable, but no one has been named as responsible.

SAUDI ARABIA / YEMEN: Coalition operation hits Ras Isa; Houthis report seven wounded

The coalition spokesman said a "targeted military operation" began on 1 November against resources the Houthis use for missile and drone attacks, without naming sites. [23] The Houthi health ministry says strikes on Ras Isa port and an oil facility in Bajil wounded seven. [24] Vanguard Tech, cited by Maritime Executive, said at

least two vessels at Ras Isa were targeted; the coalition has not confirmed this. [25] The coalition said it intercepted a Houthi ballistic missile aimed at the south. [26] The US Embassy in Riyadh told Americans to "exercise extreme caution around airports." [17]

Assessment: The Saudi-Houthi fight now targets Red Sea fuel infrastructure, putting commercial ships calling at Hodeidah-area ports at direct risk.

ISRAEL: Bennett's party backs Eisenkot; Herzog consultations begin 4 November

Together, Bennett and Lapid's 12-seat party, will recommend Eisenkot. [27] A Joint List official said the Joint List and Ra'am are expected to do the same. [28] Ynet projects 60 recommendations for Eisenkot and 46 for Netanyahu, with Yisrael Beiteinu and UTJ undecided. Herzog receives the official results and starts broadcast consultations on 4 November; MKs are sworn in on 10 November. [29] Herzog told leaders to "stop climbing trees" and find "creative solutions to prevent another election." [30]

Assessment: Eisenkot is very likely to get the first mandate, but even 60 recommendations do not make a 61-seat coalition, so Liberman and Arab outside support will decide the outcome.

ISRAEL: Election chief says results stand; Likud says "a dark cloud hangs" over them

Sohlberg, with the Shin Bet chief and the Attorney General, said that "even if the suspicions are substantiated, this does not detract from the integrity" of the election. [31][32] Likud said "only 4,612 votes" separated a Ra'am seat from the right-wing bloc and demanded a swift investigation; no court filing has been reported. [33] A judge eased restrictions on three activists arrested over alleged vote-buying. [32]

Assessment: The authorities have closed the formal route to annulling the result, so Likud's challenge is now political rather than legal.

ENERGY: Brent falls about 3% in Asian trade

Brent fell to $109.75 by 0407 GMT on Monday, down 3.2%, and WTI to $100.69. Reuters tied the drop to a third day of Iran-Qatar talks and no major weekend escalation; OPEC+ left December targets unchanged. One analyst warned Brent could reach $120 if rhetoric escalates after the midterms. [34][35]

Assessment: Prices now reflect hopes for a deal and are exposed to a sharp reversal after 3 November.

GAZA: Four killed Saturday; ministry counts 1,580 dead since the ceasefire

A teacher was killed by shelling in Nuseirat, a man died of earlier wounds, and two girls died in a tent fire in al-Mawasi of unclear cause. The Hamas-run Health Ministry reports 1,580 killed since the October 2025 ceasefire. [36]

Assessment: Low-level casualties continue while talks on the peace plan are stalled.

PAKISTAN / AFGHANISTAN: Islamabad calls terrorism a "red line"; new border fire reported

Pakistan's Information Ministry said "terrorism is a red line" and that Pakistan "reserves the right to take all necessary measures." [37] Daily Pakistan, citing unnamed officials, reports Pakistani troops hit Afghan border posts in South Waziristan after fire from the Afghan side; there is no ISPR or Taliban comment. [38]

Assessment: Border exchanges continue at a low level as both governments harden their public positions.

LEBANON: Military court charges 13 over Hezbollah explosives truck

Charges cover a truck seized at Dahr al-Baydar with 780 kg of explosives; two suspects are in custody and 11 at large. Hezbollah calls the charges "unjust" and wants the explosives returned. [39] *Pre-window onset.*

Assessment: The state is testing disarmament through the courts, which raises the risk of friction with Hezbollah.

Also noted: Syria's foreign minister said Syria's entry into the Saudi-Turkish-Pakistani "Mecca alliance" is under discussion. [40] In Iraq, at least four armed factions are competing to lead the intelligence service, according to second-hand reporting. [41]

Collection gap: No reporting found from Central Asia or Egypt. No official US force-posture statement beyond the relayed AP item. Houthi outlets and the Saudi Press Agency were not reached directly, and the 1 November Hormuz incident has no vessel identity.

// EUCOM

UKRAINE: Oleshky truce expires after about 800 evacuations; Kyiv says Russia regrouped

The six-day local ceasefire expired at 2100Z on 1 November, and Reuters saw no immediate sign that fighting had resumed. [42] Melania Trump said "nearly 800" people were evacuated, without saying how many went to each side; Foreign Minister Sybiha said those choosing Ukraine crossed into Chernihiv region via Crimea, Anapa and Belarus. [43][42] Ukraine's General Staff says Russian forces used the pause to rotate troops, fortify positions and bring in ammunition, and Russia has not commented. [43] A separate Ukrainian evacuation moved 167 civilians from parts of Kherson region. [42]

Assessment: The truce worked as a one-off, but the regrouping allegations will likely make Kyiv wary of repeating it.

UKRAINE: Russia launches 433 drones on 31 October-1 November and 193 the next night

Ukraine's Air Force said 371 of 433 drones were downed, with hits at 16 locations. [44][45] Zelensky said strikes on power infrastructure in four regions left hundreds of thousands of households without power. [46] A strike on Koziatyn killed a 13-year-old girl and a woman. [47] Overnight into 2 November, 154 of 193 drones were downed; one person was killed in Izium and 17 injured, and Izium lost power and Bila Tserkva its water supply. [48]

Assessment: Russia is again using mass drone strikes against energy and water as the heating season starts.

RUSSIA: Ukraine resumes strikes on refineries and oil logistics

Drones reportedly hit the Kstovo refinery, about 800 km from the border, overnight into 1 November; the reports could not be immediately verified. [49] Russian investigators opened a terrorism case, and Moscow said Ukraine had resumed refinery strikes after a pause. [46] Overnight into 2 November drones struck a Transneft pumping station in Samara region that feeds the Druzhba pipeline, the fifth strike there since 2 October. [50] ISW also recorded strikes on a Rostov defence plant and two Ufa refineries. [51]

Assessment: Kyiv resumed refinery strikes despite US concern about diesel prices, which could cause friction with Washington before the talks.

RUSSIA / UKRAINE: Kremlin open to a Zelensky call; talks expected after 4 November

Kremlin aide Ushakov said Putin would "of course" take a call from Zelensky and that talks could resume after Russia's 4 November holiday. Sybiha said Kyiv is ready for a leaders' meeting, with Turkey, Abu Dhabi and Switzerland discussed as hosts. Ushakov said a Putin-Trump-Xi meeting is being prepared for APEC in Shenzhen. [52] He had earlier ruled out European participation. [53]

Assessment: Moscow is signalling openness while fixing the format; no date or venue has been confirmed.

UKRAINE: Russian armour reportedly massing toward Dobropillya

ISW assessed a Ukrainian advance northeast of Borova and noted Ukrainian officials acknowledged a Russian advance near Hraniv, north of Kharkiv. A Ukrainian NCO reported Russian armour massing toward Dobropillya. ISW also noted a possible US sale of 500 PAC-3 interceptors, reportedly not for delivery until after 2030. [51]

Assessment: Armour massing near Dobropillya is the main indicator of a renewed Russian push in Donetsk.

FRANCE: 31 October protests smaller but violent; general strike on 5 November

The Interior Ministry counted about 320,000 protesters, including 70,000 in Paris, down from 410,000 on 24 October; unions claimed nearly 500,000. There were 779 arrests and 116 police and gendarmes injured, and the interior minister called a Molotov cocktail thrown at a gendarme "attempted murder." [54] The CGT and other unions have called a general strike for 5 November. [55]

Assessment: Turnout is falling but violence at the edges continues, making the 5 November strike the next test.

SERBIA: Novi Sad anniversary; senior police officers detained

Thousands marched silently in Novi Sad on 1 November to mark two years since the canopy collapse. Prosecutors ordered 48-hour detention of the chief of criminal police, accused of orchestrating violence against student protesters, which he denies. [56]

Assessment: The arrests suggest the old security apparatus is being held to account after the election, which may provoke resistance inside it.

BOSNIA AND HERZEGOVINA: No new findings on the EUFOR helicopter crash

The latest verified report says investigators are weighing a technical fault, a power-line strike or human error, with weather ruled out. [57] No new findings were reported in the window.

Assessment: Initial findings were expected within days, so a statement this week is likely.

Collection gap: No verified weekend reporting on the Spain crash investigation, Georgia, Moldova, Belarus, NATO airspace incidents or Türkiye. No ISW assessment dated 1 November could be opened.

// INDOPACOM

NORTH KOREA: Cluster-bomb warhead tested on a tactical ballistic missile

KCNA said the Missile Administration tested a "Standard Type 2" cluster warhead on 31 October that can turn "a target area of 12 to 13 hectares" into ashes, and that units will field all four cluster-warhead types "within this year." Yonhap says the missile flew from near Chongju toward the Yellow Sea; Stars and Stripes says the East Sea. [58][59][60] On 2 November a senior party official called the allied Iron Mace exercise "the most hideous nuclear war rehearsal." [61]

Assessment: Pyongyang is keeping up military pressure through weapons tests, and the year-end fielding target suggests more cluster-warhead launches.

SOUTH KOREA / NORTH KOREA: Loudspeakers still silent after the deadline

South Korea's military said on 1 and 2 November that it has not confirmed any North Korean loudspeaker broadcasts toward the South, and that residents' reports of sounds near Paju were not enough to conclude otherwise. Pyongyang has not answered Seoul's offer of military talks. [62][63]

Assessment: The threat has been deferred but not withdrawn, so the risk of tit-for-tat border broadcasts remains.

TAIWAN: Chinese coast guard intrusion at Pratas and a patrol east of Taiwan

On 31 October a China Coast Guard vessel entered restricted waters near Pratas and came within about 1 nautical mile of a Taiwanese patrol ship; Taiwan says it is the 13th such intrusion this year. [64] China's coast guard announced a "routine law enforcement patrol" east of Taiwan, and Taipei said Beijing has "no jurisdiction" there. [65] Taiwan counted 19 PLA aircraft sorties, seven navy ships and six official ships in 24 hours to 0600 on 2 November. [66] Taiwan News, citing the Wall Street Journal, reports expanded Chinese undersea mapping east and south of Taiwan. [67]

Assessment: Beijing is likely using its coast guard to make claimed jurisdiction look routine, alongside normal PLA activity.

PHILIPPINES / CHINA: Unidentified Chinese vessel inside the Scarborough Shoal lagoon

The Philippine Coast Guard is investigating a vessel in the lagoon, first seen on 3 October, that was seen on 29 October towing a smaller boat and carrying an object with sensors and antennas; its markings do not match known Chinese research ships. The PLA Southern Theater Command said on 31 October it had stepped up "combat-readiness patrols." [68] No collision or water-cannon incident was reported.

Assessment: The vessel suggests Chinese activity at the shoal may be extending to underwater survey work; this is unconfirmed.

QUAD / CHINA: Ministers voice "grave concerns" about economic coercion

Quad foreign ministers meeting in Atlanta expressed "grave concerns regarding economic coercion, including through arbitrary export restrictions," without naming China, and called for freedom of navigation in Hormuz and the Red Sea. [69] Chinese state media called the statement double standards. [70] US, South Korean and Japanese ministers called for North Korea's complete denuclearisation. [58]

Assessment: The Quad is aiming at Beijing's rare-earth export controls ahead of a likely Trump-Xi meeting.

JAPAN: Government weighs a defence plan of about $500bn

Two sources told Reuters the government is considering 70-80 trillion yen for five years from April 2027, about 1.8 times the current plan; the defence ministry declined to comment. [71]

Assessment: If adopted it would be the largest step yet in Japan's build-up and will likely draw sharp criticism from Beijing.

CHINA / US: Trump to attend APEC in Shenzhen; military commission still unfilled

Secondary reporting says Trump will attend APEC in Shenzhen on 18-19 November and is expected to meet Xi. [72] No new military commission appointments followed the plenum; Zhang Shengmin was added to the Politburo. [73]

Assessment: APEC is now the main near-term event in US-China relations, while the gutted high command remains unfilled.

MYANMAR: Arakan Army says airstrikes killed 12 civilians

The Arakan Army says strikes on 1 November in four Rakhine townships killed at least 12 civilians, including seven on a bridge and five at a maternity clinic. The junta has not commented, and the figures are unverified. [74]

Assessment: Continued reliance on air power undercuts the junta's push to regain ASEAN standing.

BANGLADESH: Garment wage protests shut about 500 factories

Protests entered a third day on 2 November, with police using tear gas. Workers want a minimum wage of 30,000 taka, and the government formed a wage board on 1 November. [75]

Assessment: Unrest in the $38bn export sector is the first major labour test for the new government.

INDONESIA: Student protests spread

Students and civil society protested in at least six cities over wildfires, education costs and civil liberties, and organisers say protests will continue. [76]

Assessment: The protests appear sustained, adding pressure on Prabowo.

Collection gap: Nothing new on Solomon Islands PM Wale's condition or an acting PM; the latest item is an opposition statement from before the window. [77] No new reporting on the Liaoning group, India-Pakistan, India-China, Australia or the Pacific. Kyodo, Yomiuri, Japan Times and SCMP did not load.

// NORTHCOM

UNITED STATES: Judge bars DOJ and DHS from pressuring election officials

On 30 October Judge Trina Thompson issued a temporary restraining order barring federal officials from threatening or coercing election workers into stopping ballot processing, removing voters or setting aside ballots based only on the administration's eligibility claims. She found the departments likely violated the Voting Rights Act. DOJ said it is "evaluating all options." [78] A legal newsletter reports an emergency stay request to the Ninth Circuit; this is not corroborated. [79] *Pre-window onset.*

Assessment: The order sets national limits on federal pressure going into Tuesday unless the Ninth Circuit stays it.

UNITED STATES: Ninth Circuit again refuses to stop California counting about 20,000 ballots

A 2-1 panel denied DOJ's renewed request, finding it likely violates the 90-day bar on systematic purges. DOJ is expected to go to the Supreme Court. [80] No Supreme Court application was found over the weekend. [79] *Pre-window onset.*

Assessment: An emergency application remains possible, but the Purcell principle weighs against changes this close to the election.

UNITED STATES: About 1,000 DOJ monitors; states restrict access

Votebeat reports DOJ plans about 1,000 monitors, up from 714 in 2024. Colorado, Indiana and Wyoming say they will keep monitors away from polling places, and Wyoming's attorney general says state law does not authorise them. [81]

Assessment: Standoffs at polling-place doors are likely in states that restrict access.

UNITED STATES: Officials prepare for intimidation; Alaska fights certification suit

ABC Four Corners reports local officials preparing for violence and intimidation and says the administration has not ruled out armed federal agents at polls. [82] Alaska asked a judge to dismiss a DOJ suit seeking to delay certification of its Senate race. [83] On 30 October Chester County, Pennsylvania, paused election work after a substance was found in a ballot envelope. [84]

Assessment: Physical security at election offices and certification fights are the main risks after polls close.

MEXICO: Sinaloa records its most violent month

Noroeste counts 201 homicide cases in Sinaloa in October, 31% more than September, and 4,130 violent deaths since the cartel's internal war began. [85]

Assessment: Violence is still rising despite federal reinforcement and the change of governor.

MEXICO: Reinforcements hold in Matamoros

Federal and state forces kept a reinforced presence in Matamoros on 31 October after blockades were cleared. The detainee is described as second-in-command of the Gulf Cartel's Ciclones faction. [86] Earlier reports put the 30 October toll at six dead. [87]

Assessment: The city is calm under heavier federal presence, but retaliation or a succession fight remains possible.

MEXICO / US: Death in ICE custody adds strain; trade deal "very close"

A Mexican green-card holder died in ICE custody in Laredo, the 18th Mexican national to die in US immigration custody or enforcement since January 2025 by Mexico News Daily's count. [88] Sheinbaum and Trump called a trade deal "very close." [89]

Assessment: Detention deaths are a growing irritant alongside the trade talks.

CANADA: Carney reports progress with Trump on trade

Carney said he had a "good conversation" with Trump and that teams will work on a deal "in the coming weeks." [90] He called six by-elections for 7 December. [91]

Assessment: The trade thaw before the midterms is the main bilateral development.

TROPICS: No Atlantic threat

NHC expects no Atlantic formation in seven days. [92] A low east-southeast of Hawaii has a 60% chance of formation in seven days. [93]

Assessment: There is no tropical threat to the NORTHCOM coastline.

Collection gap: No CISA, FBI or DHS election-security statement found in the window. No confirmed Election Day National Guard activation, and a viral claim of a 50-state mobilisation was not verified. No Supreme Court action found on Big Bend.

// SOUTHCOM

BRAZIL / US: Trump says Flávio Bolsonaro "can stay as long as he wants"

On 31 October Trump said Flávio Bolsonaro "can stay here as long as he wants," called Brazil's election "a disgrace" without evidence, and said he had no plans to meet him. Brazil's Supreme Court cancelled both his passports; he entered the US on parole on 28 October, and Federal Police say he is not a fugitive. [94] Rubio said "we did not facilitate anything" and met Brazil's foreign minister in Atlanta. [95]

Assessment: Trump's endorsement makes an asylum claim more likely to succeed and deepens the rift with Brasília, though channels remain open.

COLOMBIA: Sixth air strike on Clan del Golfo kills at least seven

President De la Espriella said the strike in Nóvita, Chocó, killed at least seven, including the structure's third-in-command. [96] El Tiempo first reported six dead. [97] EFE notes Legal Medicine counts eight minors killed across the government's bombings. [96]

Assessment: The air campaign is producing leadership kills, but deaths of minors are a growing legal and political liability.

COLOMBIA: More than 500 troops reinforce Cúcuta and Catatumbo

A rapid-deployment battalion arrived in Cúcuta for operations in Catatumbo, and the president plans a security council there this week. [98]

Assessment: A sustained military footprint is in place on the Venezuelan border.

HAITI: Gangs barricade districts ahead of Salvadoran operations

AP reports Salvadoran troops with new armoured vehicles in Tabarre and gang leaders vowing to "outgun" them; Haiti says four missing Salvadoran technicians were abducted. [99] AyiboPost reporting, via a translation blog, says only about 200 Salvadoran personnel are to come under Gang Suppression Force command and describes barricades across Santo and Croix-des-Missions. [100]

Assessment: A Salvadoran offensive near Santo is increasingly likely, and unclear command lines raise the risk of civilian harm.

PERU: Fujimori pledges "legitimate use of force"; El Niño rains

After returning from El Salvador, President Fujimori said "we will no longer wait" and plans two large new prisons. [101] She cancelled a trip to Spain after warnings of heavy rain in the north. [102]

Assessment: Peru is moving toward a Bukele-style security model while facing an El Niño emergency that may draw on the military.

VENEZUELA: Still no election date

Machado says the US roadmap aims at a 2027 presidential election, and no official date exists. [103] A prison monitor reports at least two sick detainees died in custody. [104]

Assessment: The stalemate continues; a Rodríguez-Machado meeting or electoral council announcement is the next likely trigger.

CUBA: Grid shortfall near 2,000 MW

The state utility forecast a 1,965 MW peak shortfall on 1 November against 2,900 MW demand. [105] Cuba stayed on summer time to cut peak demand. [106]

Assessment: Generation covers only about a third of peak demand, so another nationwide blackout is likely.

Collection gap: No Ecuador protest reporting in the window; the next marches are set for 7 and 15 November. Nothing found for Central America, the Venezuela oil deal or primary Haitian government statements.

// WATCH ITEMS (NEXT 72 HOURS)

- US Election Day on 3 November: DOJ monitors refused entry, federal agents at polls, and incidents at election offices. [81][82]
- Possible Ninth Circuit stay of the restraining order and a DOJ Supreme Court application on California ballots. [78][80]
- Any US strike decision after polls close, Iran's "unrestricted" response, a Rezaei reply and the two-day Hormuz offer. [15][18]
- Herzog's consultations from 4 November and recommendations from Yisrael Beiteinu and UTJ. [29]
- A date and venue for Russia-Ukraine-US talks after 4 November, and fighting around Oleshky. [52][42]

- France's 5 November general strike. [55]
- North Korean loudspeakers and further cluster-warhead tests; Chinese activity at Pratas and Scarborough. [63][58][68]
- Sudanese action against Ethiopia; Western Sahara after MINURSO; the 6 November Lissu verdict in Tanzania. [4][2]
- A Salvadoran-led offensive in Haiti and Flávio Bolsonaro's status. [100][94]

// SOURCE SUMMARY STATEMENT

This report draws on 106 open-source items published or updated between 21 October and 2 November 2026, most within the weekend window. They include international wire services (AP, AFP, Reuters, EFE, Yonhap, Anadolu) carried by PBS, Africanews, Cyprus Mail, The Star, Malay Mail, Business Standard, Arab News, Infobae and US local broadcasters; US and international outlets (ABC News, CBS News, Fox News, ABC Australia, Al Jazeera, Stars and Stripes, Times of Israel, Jerusalem Post, Ynetnews, Kyiv Post, Kyiv Independent, The Moscow Times); regional press (Korea Herald, Korea Times, Kyunghyang, Focus Taiwan, Taiwan News, Manila Times, Jakarta Post, DVB, Noroeste, La Razón, El Tiempo, Vanguardia, Le JDD, Gulf News, Asharq Al-Awsat, Pakistan Today); specialist outlets (Votebeat, Democracy Docket, Maritime Executive); think tanks (ISW, Critical Threats); and official sources (Taiwan MND, Canada's Prime Minister's Office, National Hurricane Center). Global Times, Ukrinform and Anadolu are state or state-aligned media; Al Jazeera is Qatar-funded and Qatar is a mediator in the Iran talks; Fox News, Israel National News, Democracy Docket and Middle East Monitor have partisan lines. Several items rest on unverified claims by parties to conflicts (Houthi casualty claims, Arakan Army casualty figures, Nigerian military figures, Sudanese accusations against Ethiopia). Lower-reliability or secondary sources (Substack newsletters, Dimsum Daily, CiberCuba, an opinion column in Mexico News Daily) are flagged and used only for narrow points. CNN, SCMP, Kyodo, Sudan Tribune and Hiiraan Online did not load. Coverage gaps include the Sahel, Central Asia, Central America and the Solomon Islands.

// ENDNOTES (ICD 206)

All sources accessed 2 November 2026. All sources are publicly available reporting.

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